



Monitor and maintain a business computer system

D1.HGE.CL7.05 D1.HML.CL10.04
D1.HRM.CL9.13 D2.TRM.CL9.15

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual



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for foods, tourism
& hospitality

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes
- Case studies

- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes
- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment

- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering 'Remarks' as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of 'Written Questions' for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

"These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: MONITOR AND MAINTAIN A BUSINESS COMPUTER SYSTEM		NOMINAL HOURS: 50
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HGE.CL7.05 D1.HML.CL10.04 D1.HRM.CL9.13 D2.TRM.CL9.15		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to monitor and maintain a business computer system in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Monitor effectiveness of computer equipment 1.1 Monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of <i>computer equipment</i> to ensure it meets enterprise needs through ongoing consultation with users 1.2 Monitor effectiveness through assessment of productivity and efficiency 1.3 Establish and implement procedures for identifying and resolving performance problems including use of <i>specialised assistance</i> 1.4 Identify computer training needs and provide training opportunities Element 2: Purchase hardware and software 2.1 Identify broad computer equipment hardware and <i>software</i> requirements accurately and research possible new approaches using appropriate <i>information sources</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to monitoring and maintaining a business computer system within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office 2. Housekeeping 3. Food and Beverage Service 4. Food Production 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation <i>Computer equipment</i> may include: • Screens • Hard drives

2.2 Assess <i>the feasibility</i> of acquiring or upgrading hardware and software based on available information 2.3 Evaluate options against the needs of the enterprise, including advantages and limitations 2.4 Investigate user-friendliness, system support and training issues 2.5 Seek external specialist assistance as required 2.6 Make decisions on computer acquisitions in consultation with appropriate colleagues 2.7 Plan introduction of new computer systems to take account of impacts on colleagues and customers 2.8 Ensure staff are adequately trained in using new systems 2.9 Monitor new systems for efficiency and take action accordingly	• Printers • Scanners • Back-up systems. <i>Specialised assistance</i> may include: • Internal Information Technology (IT) support • External Information Technology (IT) support • Use of commercial 'help' desks • Manufacturer. <i>Software</i> may include: • Word processing packages • Spreadsheet packages • Accounting packages • Database packages • Presentation packages • Internet browsers. <i>Information sources</i> on new technology may include: • Computer magazines and journals • Trade fairs • Computer software designers • Computer hardware manufacturers • Retail outlets • Internet
Element 3: Maintain computer equipment and systems 3.1 Establish and monitor <i>systems for cleaning, minor maintenance and replacement of consumables</i> in accordance with manufacturer's instructions 3.2 Report faults to the nominated person or supplier for rectification 3.3 Establish and monitor procedures for ensuring security of data, including regular back-ups and virus checks	

3.4 Create document filing systems and procedures to reflect the size, nature and complexity of the workplace 3.5 Set up equipment to accept the software and functions being used	• Industry associations • Seminars, workshops and training sessions • Internal/external clients. <i>Assess the feasibility</i> may relate to: • Establishing benefits and consequences • Assessing timeline for delivery and installation • Determining maintenance required • Assessing costs against available budget • Assessing technology against enterprise business plans and goals. <i>Systems for cleaning, minor maintenance and replacement of consumables</i> may relate to: • Creating more space on the hard disk • Reviewing programs • Deleting unwanted files • Cleaning dust from internal and external surfaces • Backing up files before major maintenance • Checking hard drive for errors • Decrementing the hard disk • Using up-to-date anti-virus programs.
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	Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Ability to identify sources of information and advice on computer systems relevant to the industry sector • Ability to use current technology options as appropriate to industry sector, including both hardware and software and their general features and capabilities • Overview of typical systems for computer security, filing, back-up and virus control • Knowledge of typical computer maintenance procedures conducted by operational staff as opposed to computer specialists • Knowledge of key factors in achieving productivity and efficiency from computer systems, including ability to ensure effective monitoring, reporting of faults and regular maintenance. Linkages To Other Units • Use common business tools and technology • Manage physical assets and infrastructure • Establish and maintain a business relationship • Manage and implement small projects • Access and retrieve computer based data. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Demonstration of current knowledge of the broad technological environment in which the enterprise operates and of the various options for computer technology in different industry sectors • Knowledge of and ability to use typical systems and procedures for the maintenance of computer systems
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- Demonstrated ability to review current computer technology and develop proposals for upgrading of equipment and software
- Demonstrated ability to evaluate computerised filing systems, back-up or virus procedures
- Knowledge, understanding and skill in producing documents, reports and worksheets on a computer.

Context of Assessment

This unit may be assessed on or off the job:

- Assessment should include practical demonstration of the completion or project or work activities that required the candidate to monitor current technology and evaluate new technology for a specific business purpose
- Assessment must relate to the individual's work area, job role and area of responsibility
- Assessment must include project or work activities that allow the candidate to respond to multiple and varying workplace situations and demonstrate an ability to maintain a business computer system.

Resource Implications

Training and assessment to include access to a variety of computerised systems appropriate to the industry sector or enterprise in a real or simulated workplace; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools, computer equipment and relevant software.

Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Case studies
- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Oral and written questions
- Portfolio evidence

	• Problem solving • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Review and analyse literature on different computer systems or software
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Demonstrate how to perform basic computer maintenance to team members
	Planning and organising activities	3	Organise work flow to facilitate the smooth introduction of new computer equipment
	Working with others and in teams	2	Identify computer training needs and provide appropriate support to team members
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	0	
	Solving problems	1	Identify technology to solve administrative problems
	Using technology	2	Ensure optimum computer performance by utilising computer system software, e.g. PC Tools.

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Monitor and maintain a business computer system D1.HGE.CL7.05 D1.HML.CL10.04 D1.HRM.CL9.13 D2.TRM.CL9.15
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Why is it important to understand the effectiveness of current computer assets when deciding on the need for a new computer system?	☐	☐
2. What aspects of the current computer system would you monitor to determine its effectiveness?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Why is it important to identify computer faults in a timely manner?	☐	☐
4. Before conducting computer straining, how can you check the current competency of staff?	☐	☐
5. What does LAN stand for? Describe the purpose of a LAN.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What does the term 'feasibility' mean?	☐	☐
7. How can you evaluate options between different suppliers of computer assets?	☐	☐
8. What types of external computer related services and support are available in your region?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Why is it important to utilise external advice when purchasing a new computer system?	☐	☐
10. What are different methods of financing that can be used to acquire computer system assets?	☐	☐
11. What tasks are associated with the implementation of computer system assets?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Why is it important to ensure staff are adequately trained before using new computer systems?	☐	☐
13. What methods can be used to monitor the success of new computer assets?	☐	☐
14. What is the purpose of having a 'preventative maintenance' program?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. Who should computer faults be reported to and why?	☐	☐
16. Provide two examples of how to back up computer data.	☐	☐
17. How can data be stored in a computer system?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. What types of support can you provide to staff when implementing new computer system equipment?	☐	☐

Written questions

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Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are three key assets of a business computer system?

2. Who are possible stakeholders that may be involved in determining business computer system asset needs?

3. What are two computer system asset management activities?

4. What systems or methods can be used to monitor the condition and performance of a business computer system?

5. How can you identify or anticipate faults?

6. What are examples of common computer faults?

7. What are four examples of general computer system knowledge and skills that staff must be trained in before using computer systems?

8. What are three sources of computer system information?

9. Describe the internet service providers in your region. What are considerations when selecting an ISP?

10. Provide an example of how a business computer system will use both wired and wireless networks.

11. What are the different types of personal computers than can be used in a business computer system?

12. What are common software functions?

13. What are purchasing considerations when purchasing a new computer system?

14. What feasibility activities are performed when deciding on a new computer system?

15. What are three key non-finance purchasing priorities when acquiring a computer system?

16. Identify two companies in your region that may be helpful in obtaining computer support services.

17. What are two pieces of advice or assistance can be obtained from the companies for identified in Question 16?

18. What are examples of costs associated with purchasing a computer system?

19. What are examples of benefits associated with purchasing a computer system?

20. What are three considerations when implementing a new computer system?

21. What information needs to be communicated to staff when implementing a new computer system?

22. What are three examples of specialised knowledge or skills that staff need to understand before using GDS and CRS systems?

23. What are types of computer system training that can be utilised?

24. What are examples of key performance indicators that can be monitored and measured to determine the success of new computer systems?

25. What are examples of maintenance activities that can be used to maintain computer equipment?

26. What are considerations when scheduling maintenance of computer assets?

27. What actions can be taken when computer faults are identified?

28. What are methods you can use to prevent the impact of computer viruses?

29. What are examples of policies and procedures than can be implemented to control the use and security of data?

30. What are two examples of predictable problems that may occur when implementing new computer system assets? Identify how you can minimise the damage of these problems?

Answers to written questions

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The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What are three key assets of a business computer system?

- Internet service provider
- Modem
- Router
- Network card
- Servers
- Wired or Ethernet networks
- Wireless networks
- Local area network (LAN)
- Network security
- Personal Computers (PC's)
- Monitors
- Keyboards
- Mouse
- Scanners
- Printers
- Multifunction devices (MFDs)
- Back-up systems.

2. Who are possible stakeholders that may be involved in determining business computer system asset needs?

- Owners of the business
- Managers
- Supervisors
- Staff, teams and workgroups
- Customers
- Suppliers
- IT consultants.

3. What are two computer system asset management activities?

- Planning for assets
- Creating or acquiring new assets
- Accounting for assets and determining the actual cost of the services they provide
- Operating and maintaining assets
- Monitoring performance and condition of assets
- Assessing refurbishment, renewal and replacement options
- Disposing of assets that are no longer required
- Auditing the way in which assets are managed and the asset management practices and procedures
- Identifying and working to minimise life cycle costs of new assets.

4. What systems or methods can be used to monitor the condition and performance of a business computer system?

- Integration of reporting into day to day operating procedures
- Regular management reports
- Internal and external inspections and audits
- Regular staff feedback
- Analysis of maintenance costs over a period of time.

5. How can you identify or anticipate faults?

- The preparation of a scheduled maintenance program
- Routine checking of equipment
- Reading the instruction booklets
- Encouraging feedback from colleagues
- Keeping a log book of detected faults
- Performing regular OSH inspections.

6. What are examples of common computer faults?

- Computer is too slow
- Internet downloads or uploads slow
- Computer won't start up
- Windows won't boot
- Computer keeps restarting on its own
- Monitor is blank
- Abnormally functioning operating system or software
- Strange noises
- Overheating
- Pop-up ads keep appearing
- READY light is not lit, or is glowing red
- Self-test labels will not print
- Labels will not feed, or feed continuously
- Flat batteries, or batteries have been removed
- Electricity cord has been accidentally knocked out or the plug has been removed
- Printer won't work
- Poor print quality
- Internet not connecting
- Wi-Fi keeps disconnecting
- Data or other connections have worked loose, or dropped out
- Can't open email attachments
- Can't email other people
- Programs aren't working on your PC
- Power point is switched 'on' but the machine is turned 'off'
- Scanner not reading at all, reading partially, or reading incorrectly
- Lack of signal from scanner to register/terminal – host stops responding
- Toner or ink has run out
- Paper-rolls have run out, or paper has jammed
- EFTPOS landline connection cannot be made to the bank, or connection is very slow
- Equipment malfunction or breakdown
- Power failure
- Operator error has caused the system or equipment to freeze
- Screen is frozen.

7. What are four examples of general computer system knowledge and skills that staff must be trained in before using computer systems?

- Basic computer and keyboarding skills
- Literacy skills
- Read, interpret and use system codes
- Writing skills
- Numeracy skills
- Organisation's policies, plans and procedures
- Correct log-on and shut-down procedures
- Procedures and codes required to enter and exit a system
- Back-up and virus protection procedures
- Role of computer and operations systems
- Range of products and services
- Range of sales, operational and accounting functions
- Common computerised reservation and operational entries
- Mandatory fields
- Applying access codes
- Interpreting and using on-screen prompts
- Interpreting and applying on-screen abbreviations, acronyms and options
- Using navigation tools such as buttons and tabs
- Applying correct date formats within the system
- Adhering to system protocols and field size limitations
- Completing required fields
- Describing the field and menu links available between screens
- Responding to system-related queries
- Accepting, confirming, denying, amending or following-up bookings
- Forwarding sub-menu bookings
- Translating communications into other languages
- Converting currencies
- Integrating updates from suppliers
- Negotiating new deals
- Adding distribution channels to the CRS network
- Generating invoices, accounts, folios and statements
- Generating and distributing relevant reports to other system users

- Requirements for specific formatted entries
- Procedures for confirming, storing and retrieving reservations or operational data
- Procedures for sending and receiving messages
- Maintenance activities
- Technical terminology in relation to reading help-files and manuals
- Methods of detecting faults in and solving problems with technology.

8. What are three sources of computer system information?

- Computer magazines and journals
- Trade fairs
- Computer software designers
- Computer hardware manufacturers
- Retail outlets
- Internet
- Industry associations
- Seminars, workshops and training sessions
- Internal/external clients.

9. Describe the internet service providers in your region. What are considerations when selecting an ISP?

Answers will vary.

Considerations when selecting an ISP include:

- Speed
- Price
- Ease of installation
- Service record
- Technical support
- Contract terms.

10. Provide an example of how a business computer system will use both wired and wireless networks

- Desktop - connected to the Internet with an Ethernet cable
- Laptop computer - connected via a wireless router

11. What are the different types of personal computers than can be used in a business computer system?

- Desktops
- Laptops
- Netbooks
- Tablet computers
- Thin clients.

12. What are common software functions?

- Word processing
- Spreadsheets
- Databases
- Communication
- Presentation
- Sharing
- Internet browsers
- Accounting software
- Groupware and collaboration.

13. What are purchasing considerations when purchasing a new computer system?

- Cost
- Availability
- Warranties and after-sales service
- Lead times
- Service centre locations
- Interruptions related to servicing
- Parts and replacement policies
- Product quality
- Reliability, suitability of use and durability
- Continuity of supply
- Terms of trade
- Rebates and discounts
- Staff training provided by suppliers
- Incentives to purchase.

14. What feasibility activities are performed when deciding on a new computer system?

- Identify the best method of acquiring required components
- Identifying advantages and disadvantages of each acquisition method
- Researching the different options that exist for the desired computer asset
- Assessing costs against available budget.

15. What are three key non-finance purchasing priorities when acquiring a computer system?

- Ease of use of the asset
- Ease of integration into the existing workplace
- Reliability of the item
- Safety
- Compliance
- Asset achieves or exceeds the results/outcomes expected of it
- Resale value
- Enhanced service levels
- Support services
- Training requirements and training provided by suppliers.

16. Identify two companies in your region that may be helpful in obtaining computer support services

Answers will vary.

17. What are two pieces of advice or assistance can be obtained from the companies for identified in Question 16?

Answers will vary.

18. What are examples of costs associated with purchasing a computer system?

- Purchase price
- Opportunity cost
- Cost of finance
- Testing or compliance costs
- Transportation costs
- Site preparation costs
- Installation costs
- Make-ready costs
- Tooling, parts and suppliers
- Spare parts costs
- Training costs
- Cost of power and consumables
- Service and maintenance costs
- Insurance costs for the new item
- Cost of adapting existing systems and procedures to accommodate the new purchase
- Lost sales caused by interruption to normal business
- Reduced levels of earnings while staff learn the new item
- Depreciation.

19. What are examples of benefits associated with purchasing a computer system?

- Higher levels of earnings/revenue
- Reduced levels of unsatisfactory services
- Energy savings
- Labour savings
- Savings on raw materials
- Sale value of any equipment that is being disposed
- Enhanced image or market positioning.

20. What are three considerations when implementing a new computer system?

- Identify all implementation actions to be taken
- Allocation of responsibilities for action to nominated persons
- Determination of accountability for actions taken
- Timelines for completion of nominated actions
- Compliance requirements
- Occupational safety and health (OSH)
- Arranging arrival and security of new computer assets
- Timing of new system assets to be implemented
- Saving information from old system assets
- Removal, storage and sale of old computer assets
- Arranging location and physical layout of new assets
- Unpacking and installing new computer assets
- Timing issues
- Resources
- Aligning new computer assets to existing structures, hardware and software systems
- Integration with other aspects of the business
- Adding information to new computer system assets
- Changes to policies and procedures
- Documentation & record keeping
- Impact on organisational culture
- Anticipation of problems
- Training for staff.

21. What information needs to be communicated to staff when implementing a new computer system?

- Reasoning or purpose behind the changes to the computer system
- Identification of the key changes that are taking place
- Identification of how the new computer system will benefit them
- Start dates of implementation
- Expected completion dates
- How the implementation will be implemented
- Activities to be performed
- Resources required to implement the plan
- Work breakdown
- Involvement of other staff
- Roles and responsibilities of staff
- Pre-change activities
- Timelines for implementation
- Training activities that will take place
- Support mechanisms
- Expected standard of performance
- Milestones for completion
- Budgets to work within
- Methods of communication
- Making observations and providing feedback.

22. What are three examples of specialised knowledge of skills that staff need to understand before using GDS and CRS systems?

- Signing on and off
- Using system passwords
- Understand online system help
- System help facilities
- Key functions
- System abbreviations
- Encoding and decoding
- Displaying and interpreting availability screens
- Selling from availability screens and making direct sell reservations
- Identifying the various levels of selling
- Creating and updating files
- Completing the Booking File
- Using service requests to generate passenger specific requirements
- Accessing and actioning queues
- Displaying fares, interpreting fare rules, and obtaining fare quotes
- Identifying and updating booking status codes.
- E-ticketing
- Accessing general information
- Completing documentation
- Client and Trip file management and accounting.

23. What are types of computer system training that can be utilised?

- Participating in formal training which may be provided by the property or by the software supplier
- Utilisation of dedicated training software
- Reading the User's manual
- Observing and listening to an experienced operator
- Asking questions
- Writing your own notes
- On-going coaching and mentoring.

24. What are examples of key performance indicators that can be monitored and measured to determine the success of new computer systems?

- Satisfaction
- System usage
- Performance/ usefulness
- Productivity
- Value analysis
- Cost-benefit analysis.

25. What are examples of maintenance activities that can be used to maintain computer equipment?

- Preventative maintenance
- Regular maintenance and servicing
- Repairs
- Physical cleaning of assets
- Cleaning of systems and internal memory
- Replacing consumables.

26. What are considerations when scheduling maintenance of computer assets?

- Labour available - in-house or contract
- Materials and parts available
- Special operation needs
- Contingencies allowed for sudden emergency call-backs
- Minimised impact on overall operability of the facility
- Most efficient cost
- Minimised customer awareness
- Minimum downtime
- Quick start-up and return to operability.

27. What actions can be taken when computer faults are identified?

- Note details of the fault
- Notify the appropriate in-house IT expert
- Check manual for trouble shooting hints
- Utilise help desk, on-line help, etc.
- Call in IT support for a service call
- Record notification of a service call
- Equipment should be removed from service
- Equipment should be labelled clearly as 'Out of Service'
- Equipment should be stored in the appropriate out of service area
- Appropriate report fault paperwork should be completed and submitted
- Returning the item to the supplier or forwarding it to an accredited repairer.
- In extreme cases, a new item may have to be purchased
- Monitor repairs made.

28. What are methods you can use to prevent the impact of computer viruses?

- Install antivirus tools
- Keep computer current with latest updates
- Run regular virus checks
- Run regular scandisk facility.

29. What are examples of policies and procedures than can be implemented to control the use and security of data?

- Administration requirements
- Internal accounting systems
- Authorised use of equipment
- Security
- Confidentiality
- Timing and frequency requirements.

30. What are two examples of predictable problems that may occur when implementing new computer system assets? Identify how you can minimise the damage of these problems?

- Delays in implementation
 - Frustrations with new systems
 - Insufficient physical space or area
 - Lack of seamless integration between old and new systems
 - Greater stress as workload increases and productivity reduces
 - Staff are unfamiliar with new systems
 - Staff unable to perform functions on new systems
 - Staff making mistakes in new system
 - Greater complaints due to delays and inaccurate information
 - Lost data
 - Limited access due to new security of password procedures
 - Disruptions to routine
 - Problems with productivity
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Monitor and maintain a business computer system D1.HGE.CL7.05 D1.HML.CL10.04 D1.HRM.CL9.13 D2.TRM.CL9.15
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Monitor effectiveness of computer equipment - Purchase hardware and software - Maintain computer equipment and systems - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Monitor effectiveness of computer equipment		
Monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of computer equipment to ensure it meets enterprise needs through ongoing consultation with users	☐	☐
Monitor effectiveness through assessment of productivity and efficiency	☐	☐
Establish and implement procedures for identifying and resolving performance problems including use of specialised assistance	☐	☐
Identify computer training needs and provide training opportunities	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Purchase hardware and software		
Identify broad computer equipment hardware and software requirements accurately and research possible new approaches using appropriate information sources	☐	☐
Assess the feasibility of acquiring or upgrading hardware and software based on available information	☐	☐
Evaluate options against the needs of the enterprise, including advantages and limitations	☐	☐
Investigate user-friendliness, system support and training issues	☐	☐
Seek external specialist assistance as required	☐	☐
Make decisions on computer acquisitions in consultation with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐
Plan introduction of new computer systems to take account of impacts on colleagues and customers	☐	☐
Ensure staff are adequately trained in using new systems	☐	☐
Monitor new systems for efficiency and take action accordingly	☐	☐
Element 3: Maintain computer equipment and systems		
Establish and monitor systems for cleaning, minor maintenance and replacement of consumables in accordance with manufacturer's instructions	☐	☐
Report faults to the nominated person or supplier for rectification	☐	☐
Establish and monitor procedures for ensuring security of data, including regular back-ups and virus checks	☐	☐
Create document filing systems and procedures to reflect the size, nature and complexity of the workplace	☐	☐
Set up equipment to accept the software and functions being used	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other <i>Please specify: _____</i> <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Monitor and maintain a business computer system D1.HGE.CL7.05 D1.HML.CL10.04 D1.HRM.CL9.13 D2.TRM.CL9.15		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Monitor effectiveness of computer equipment			
Monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of computer equipment to ensure it meets enterprise needs through ongoing consultation with users	☐	☐	☐
Monitor effectiveness through assessment of productivity and efficiency	☐	☐	☐
Establish and implement procedures for identifying and resolving performance problems including use of specialised assistance	☐	☐	☐
Identify computer training needs and provide training opportunities	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 2: Purchase hardware and software			
Identify broad computer equipment hardware and software requirements accurately and research possible new approaches using appropriate information sources	☐	☐	☐
Assess the feasibility of acquiring or upgrading hardware and software based on available information	☐	☐	☐
Evaluate options against the needs of the enterprise, including advantages and limitations	☐	☐	☐
Investigate user-friendliness, system support and training issues	☐	☐	☐
Seek external specialist assistance as required	☐	☐	☐
Make decisions on computer acquisitions in consultation with appropriate colleagues	☐	☐	☐
Plan introduction of new computer systems to take account of impacts on colleagues and customers	☐	☐	☐
Ensure staff are adequately trained in using new systems	☐	☐	☐
Monitor new systems for efficiency and take action accordingly	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Maintain computer equipment and systems			
Establish and monitor systems for cleaning, minor maintenance and replacement of consumables in accordance with manufacturer's instructions	☐	☐	☐
Report faults to the nominated person or supplier for rectification	☐	☐	☐
Establish and monitor procedures for ensuring security of data, including regular back-ups and virus checks	☐	☐	☐
Create document filing systems and procedures to reflect the size, nature and complexity of the workplace	☐	☐	☐
Set up equipment to accept the software and functions being used	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student			
Name of Assessor/s			
Unit of Competency	Monitor and maintain a business computer system	D1.HGE.CL7.05 D1.HRM.CL9.13	D1.HML.CL10.04 D2.TRM.CL9.15
Date assessment commenced			
Date assessment finalised			
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)		
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)			
Comments/observations by assessor/s			

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Monitor effectiveness of computer equipment						
Monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of computer equipment to ensure it meets enterprise needs through ongoing consultation with users						
Monitor effectiveness through assessment of productivity and efficiency						
Establish and implement procedures for identifying and resolving performance problems including use of specialised assistance						
Identify computer training needs and provide training opportunities						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Purchase hardware and software						
Identify broad computer equipment hardware and software requirements accurately and research possible new approaches using appropriate information sources						
Assess the feasibility of acquiring or upgrading hardware and software based on available information						
Evaluate options against the needs of the enterprise, including advantages and limitations						
Investigate user-friendliness, system support and training issues						
Seek external specialist assistance as required						
Make decisions on computer acquisitions in consultation with appropriate colleagues						
Plan introduction of new computer systems to take account of impacts on colleagues and customers						
Ensure staff are adequately trained in using new systems						
Monitor new systems for efficiency and take action accordingly						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Maintain computer equipment and systems						
Establish and monitor systems for cleaning, minor maintenance and replacement of consumables in accordance with manufacturer's instructions						
Report faults to the nominated person or supplier for rectification						
Establish and monitor procedures for ensuring security of data, including regular back-ups and virus checks						
Create document filing systems and procedures to reflect the size, nature and complexity of the workplace						
Set up equipment to accept the software and functions being used						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

